

Vulnerability Assessment Report

10th February 2026

Scenario

Here, I am a newly hired cybersecurity analyst for an e-commerce company. The company stores information on a remote database server, since many of the employees work remotely from locations all around the world. Employees of the company regularly query, or request, data from the server to find potential customers. The database has been open to the public since the company's launch three years ago. As a cybersecurity professional, I recognize that keeping the database server open to the public is a serious vulnerability.

My task is to completing a vulnerability assessment of the situation to communicate the potential risks to decision makers at the company. I must also create a written report that explains how the vulnerable server is a risk to business operations and how it can be secured.

System Description

The server hardware consists of a powerful CPU processor and 128GB of memory. It runs on the latest version of Linux operating system and hosts a MySQL database management system. It is configured with a stable network connection using IPv4 addresses and interacts with other servers on the network. Security measures include SSL/TLS encrypted connections.

Scope

The scope of this vulnerability assessment relates to the current access controls of the system. The assessment will cover a period of three months, from February 2026 to May 2026. [NIST SP 800-30 Rev. 1](#) is used to guide the risk analysis of the information system.

Purpose

The database server is a centralized computer system that stores and manages large amounts of data. The server is used to store customer, campaign, and analytic data that can later be analyzed to track performance and personalize marketing efforts. It is critical to secure the system because of its regular use for marketing operations.

Risk Assessment

Threat source	Threat event	Likelihood	Severity	Risk
<i>Hacker</i>	<i>Obtain sensitive information via exfiltration</i>	3	3	9
<i>Employee</i>	<i>Disrupt mission-critical operations</i>	2	3	6
<i>Customer</i>	<i>Alter/Delete critical information</i>	1	3	3

Approach

Risks that were measured considered the data storage and management procedures of the business. Potential threat sources and events were determined using the likelihood of a security incident given the open access permissions of the information system. The severity of potential incidents were weighed against the impact on day-to-day operational needs.

Remediation Strategy

Implementation of authentication, authorization, and auditing mechanisms to ensure that only authorized users access the database server. This includes using strong passwords, role-based access controls, and multi-factor authentication to limit user privileges. Encryption of data in motion using TLS instead of SSL. IP allow-listing to corporate offices to prevent random users from the internet from connecting to the database.